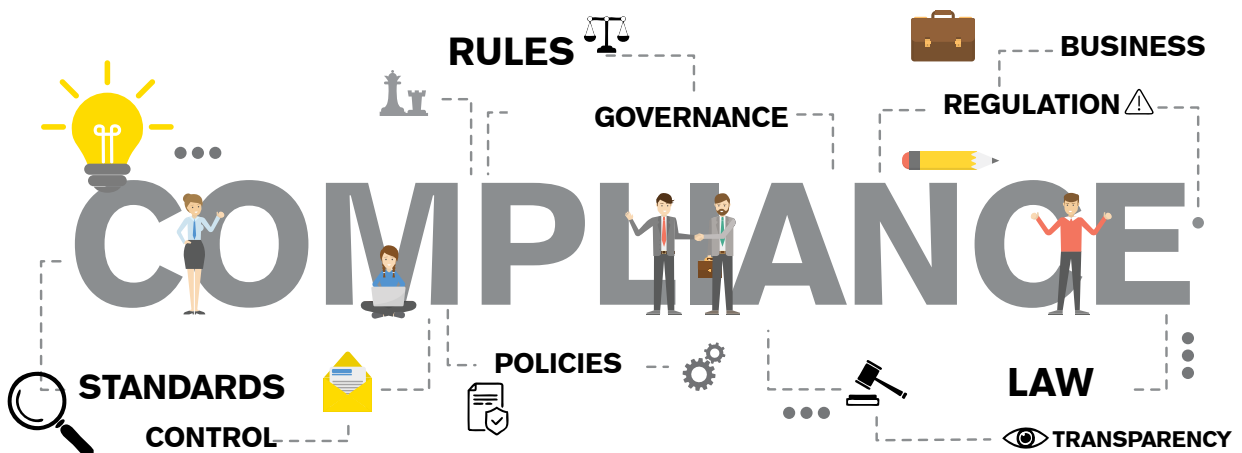


Are You Ensuring Open Source Compliance? If Not, It's Time to Do So

Open source codes, libraries and designs are all available for use against a licence.

As a developer and a user, you must make sure you are aware of the various compliances required, and also ensure that your software complies with these.



Open source compliance is a process by which open source users, integrators and developers satisfy the licence obligations implicit in their open source software components. A well-designed open source compliance process will help organisations protect their intellectual property.

First step to compliance: Awareness

A lot of companies do not consider themselves as open source companies. And because of that, their business leaders don't believe they need to manage open source. But, in reality, all software developed today consumes open source components, libraries

and frameworks. This use of open source carries a few risks, which are then passed on to customers. Indian developers have contributed hugely to a lot of open source projects like Soda and HarmonyOS on a global scale. Open source compliance is today mandatory to ensure that there are no issues in the use of these projects.

Sriharsha Narayanam, lead architect, Huawei Technologies India Pvt Ltd, points out three scenarios where one must consider compliance. The first is the open source project that is developed and hosted, where the highest responsibility and obligations lie with the creator. The second is when developers contribute to third party open source projects,

which comes with a lot of shared responsibility. The final scenario is when we use open source projects. "Give enough attention to each of the scenarios — be it with respect to the tooling or the guidelines. The key responsibility is to create awareness among all the members joining open source projects," says Narayanam.

Martin Callinan, director, Source Code Control India Pvt Ltd, a company that provides services to manage licensing, says, "Training programmes should be provided about what needs to be managed and how to manage it. The companies can be helped in making policies. For instance, the organisation may have intellectual property (IP) value in the software,